



How to get involved with Postgres without being a PG expert?

Claire Giordano

She/Her

Head of Postgres community efforts @ Microsoft



Claire Giordano

Open source champion
Microsoft



Head of Postgres & Citus open-source community efforts at Microsoft.

Alum of Citus Data, Amazon, Sun Microsystems, and Brown University CS. Conference speaker at PGConf EU, FOSDEM, PGConf NYC, Nordic PGDay, & Swiss PGDay.

Chair of Talk Selection Team for Citus Con: An Event for Postgres. Loves sailing in Greece.

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 citusdata.com/blog/authors/claire-giordano

Who is this Postgres talk for?



You're just
starting to use
Postgres

Who is this Postgres talk for?



You're just
starting to use
Postgres



New job in a
Postgres
company!

Who is this Postgres talk for?



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Postgres



New job in a
Postgres
company!



Looking for a
“side gig”

Who is this Postgres talk for?



You're just starting to use Postgres



New job in a Postgres company!



Looking for a "side gig"



You have Postgres friends & you want to get involved

Who is this Postgres talk for?



You're just starting to use Postgres



New job in a Postgres company!



Looking for a "side gig"



You have Postgres friends & you want to get involved



Pivoting from another DB to Postgres & want to contribute

Once Upon A Time...



6.5 years ago, I was
in a “**new job in a
Postgres company**”

Just like racing sailboats

All these different ways of contributing to Postgres add value

Source: Livestream of Rolex Big Boats Racing Series, Sep 2021
(my son was on the crew!)



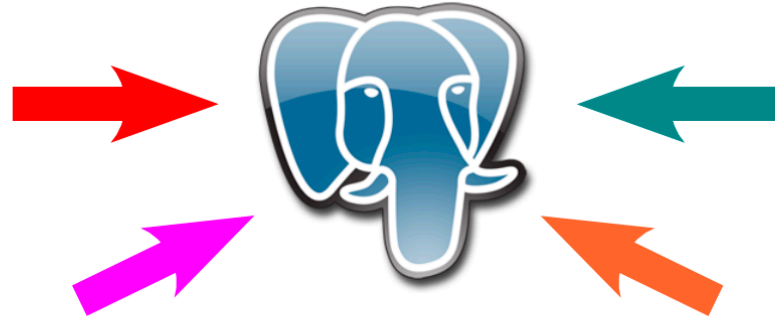
That's my son

Looks like he's paying
attention to the spinnaker?

Source: Livestream of Rolex Big Boats Racing Series, Sep 2021
(my son was on the crew!)



Josh Berkus gave a similar talk in ~2013

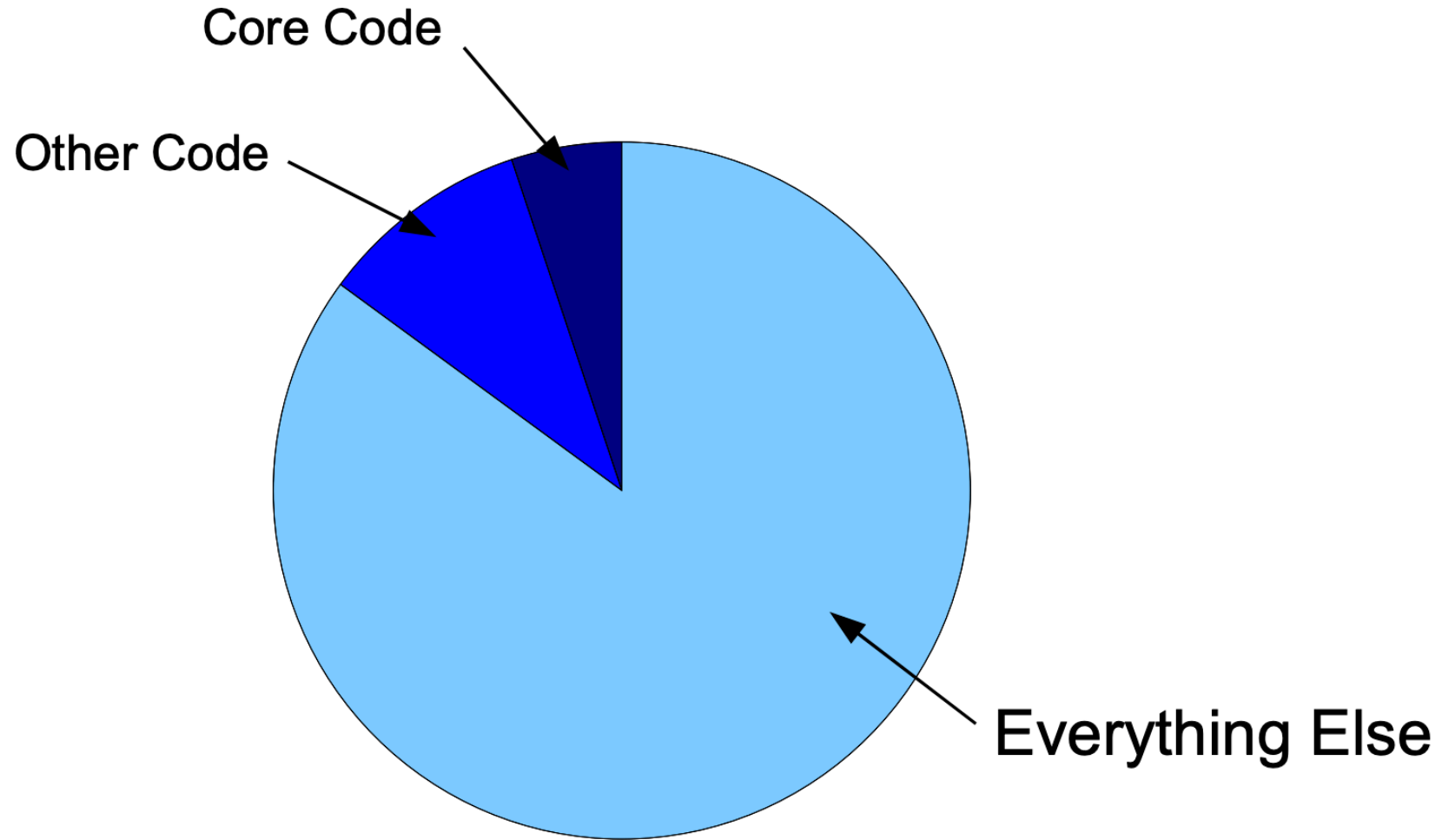


How to contribute to PostgreSQL

or, 50 Ways To Love Your Project

Source: Josh Berkus on GitHub: https://jberkus.github.io/pdf_presos/50_ways.pdf

This is how Josh drew “Contribution Pie” in 2013



I know a guy who used to say parents have 3 ways to support their children's universities (beyond tuition)

Three “T”s

- Time
- Treasure (\$\$\$)
- Talent (unique skills)



Ways to Get Involved With Postgres, in today's talk

SHARE

FEEDBACK

INSPIRE

CONVERSATION

DONATE

Ways to Get Involved With Postgres, in today's talk

SHARE

1. User experiences
2. Today I Learned / My First 6 Months
3. Video Demos
4. Social Media

CONVERSATION

5. Online Q&A
6. Hallway Track @ Events
7. Support Meetups

FEEDBACK

8. Doc feedback
9. Report bugs
10. Test new releases

DONATE

11. Language skills
12. Design skills
13. #Sketchnotes skills
14. Sponsorships

INSPIRE

15. Shine light on others
16. Say thank you!

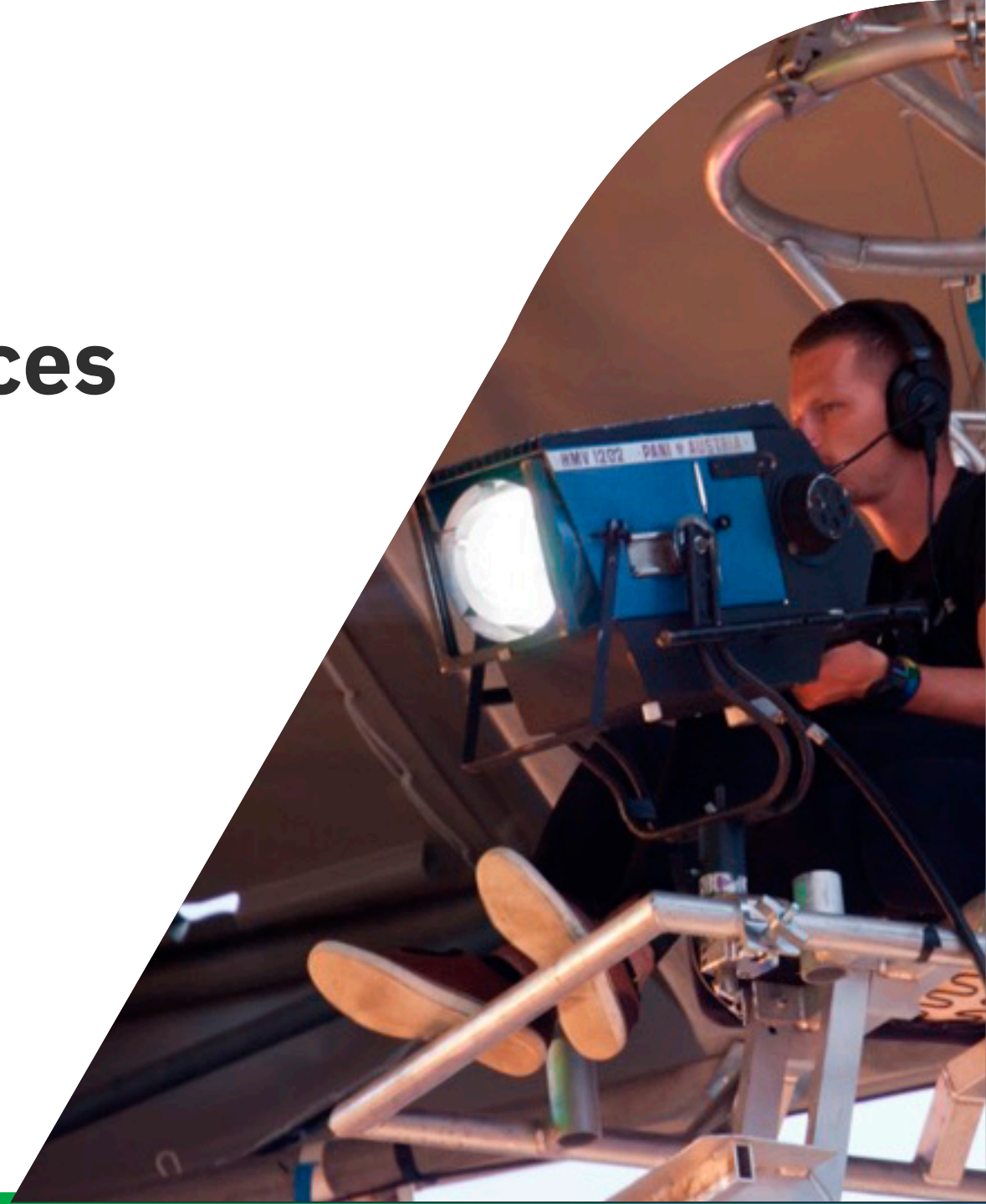


**Share your user
experiences**

1

Share your user experiences

- Blog posts
- Talks
- Podcast interviews
- Twitter/Mastodon/Threads
- PGSQL Phriday blogs
- Official “case studies”



A person wearing a VR headset and a black shirt is seated in a laboratory setting, surrounded by complex metal scaffolding and equipment. The scene is dimly lit, with some equipment labeled 'HMY 1202' and 'PANI + AUSTRIA'.

1

Tips for telling user stories

- Blog posts
- Talks
- Podcast interviews
- Twitter/Mastodon/Threads
- PGSQL Phriday Blogs
- Official “case studies”

REMEMBER:

1. Headlines
2. Scannability
3. Diagrams
4. Tables
5. Bullets
6. Code blocks

1

More Tips: My talk from PGConfEU 2022

with tips & checklists

Source: aka.ms/claire-slides-blogging-tips-pgconfeu2022

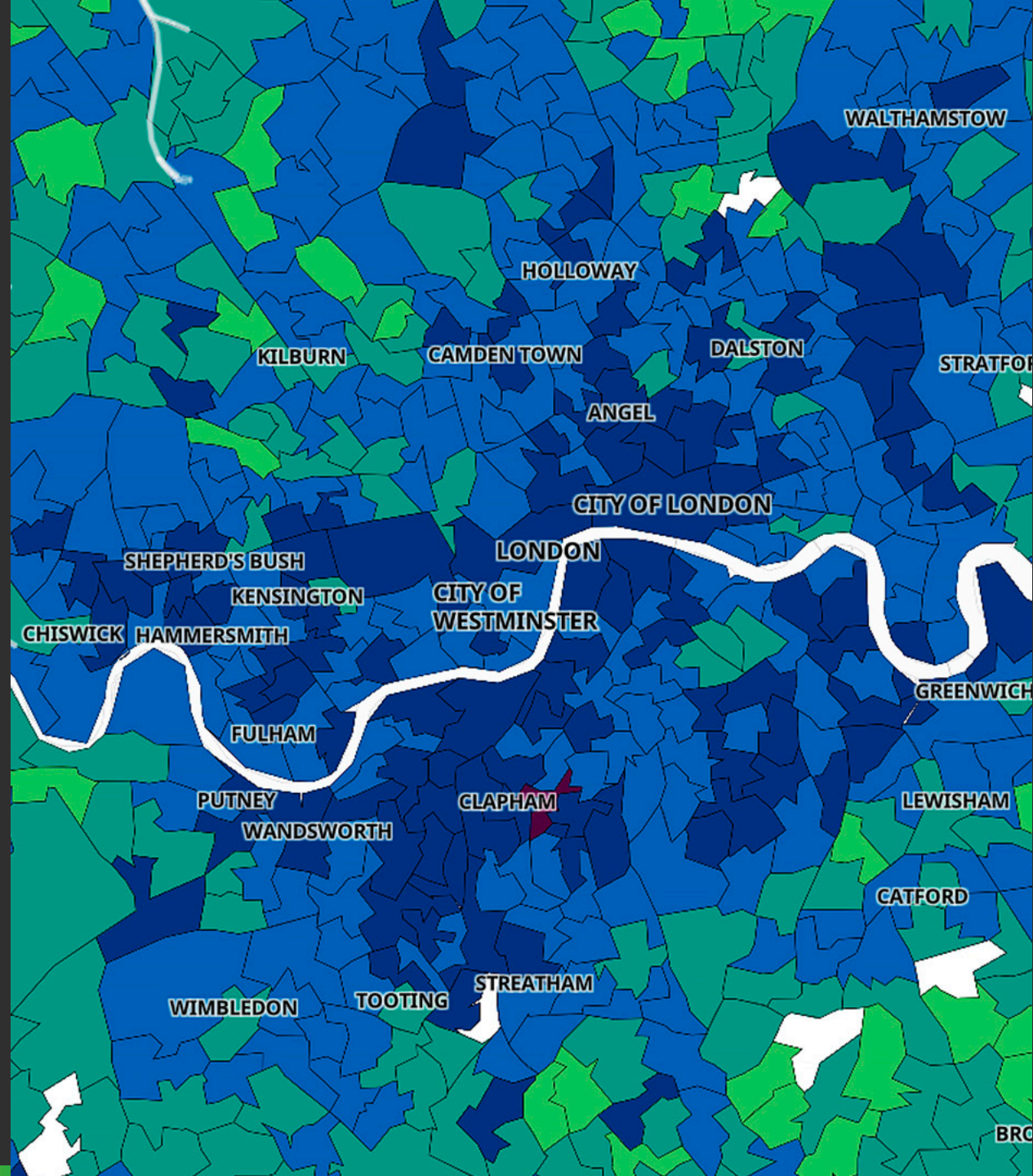


1

Example: Pouria Hadjibagheri of UKHSA co-authored post on implementation of UK COVID-19 dashboard

~83.2 K views & growing

Source: aka.ms/blog-ukcovid19-dashboard-citus





Today I Learned / My First 6 Months

2

Example: “Today I Learned”

So much to learn from
Simon Willison’s “work in public”

Source: til.simonwillison.net/

Simon Willison’s TILs

Verifying your GitHub profile on Mastodon

Mastodon has a really neat way of implementing verification, using the [rel=me microformat](#).

You can edit your Mastodon profile and add up to four links to it. Mine [looks like this](#) at the moment:

Simon Willison

@simon@simonwillison.net

Open source developer building tools to help journalists, archivists, librarians and others analyze, explore and publish their data. [datasette.io](#) and many others.

JOINED



2

Example: “Today I Learned”

Has published a TON of these
TILs since started in ~2020 I think?

Source: til.simonwillison.net/

Simon Willison's TILs

Verifying your GitHub profile on Mastodon

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You can edit your Mastodon profile and add up to four links to it. Mine [looks like this](#) at the moment:

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Open source developer building tools to help journalists, archivists, librarians and others analyze, explore and publish their data. [datasette.io](#) and many others.

JOINED



477

2

Example: My First 6 Months

PGConf.EU
Berlin
2022 

Takeaways from the First 6 Months of Hacking on Postgres

Melih Mutlu

@melihmtl

PGConf.EU 2022, Berlin





3

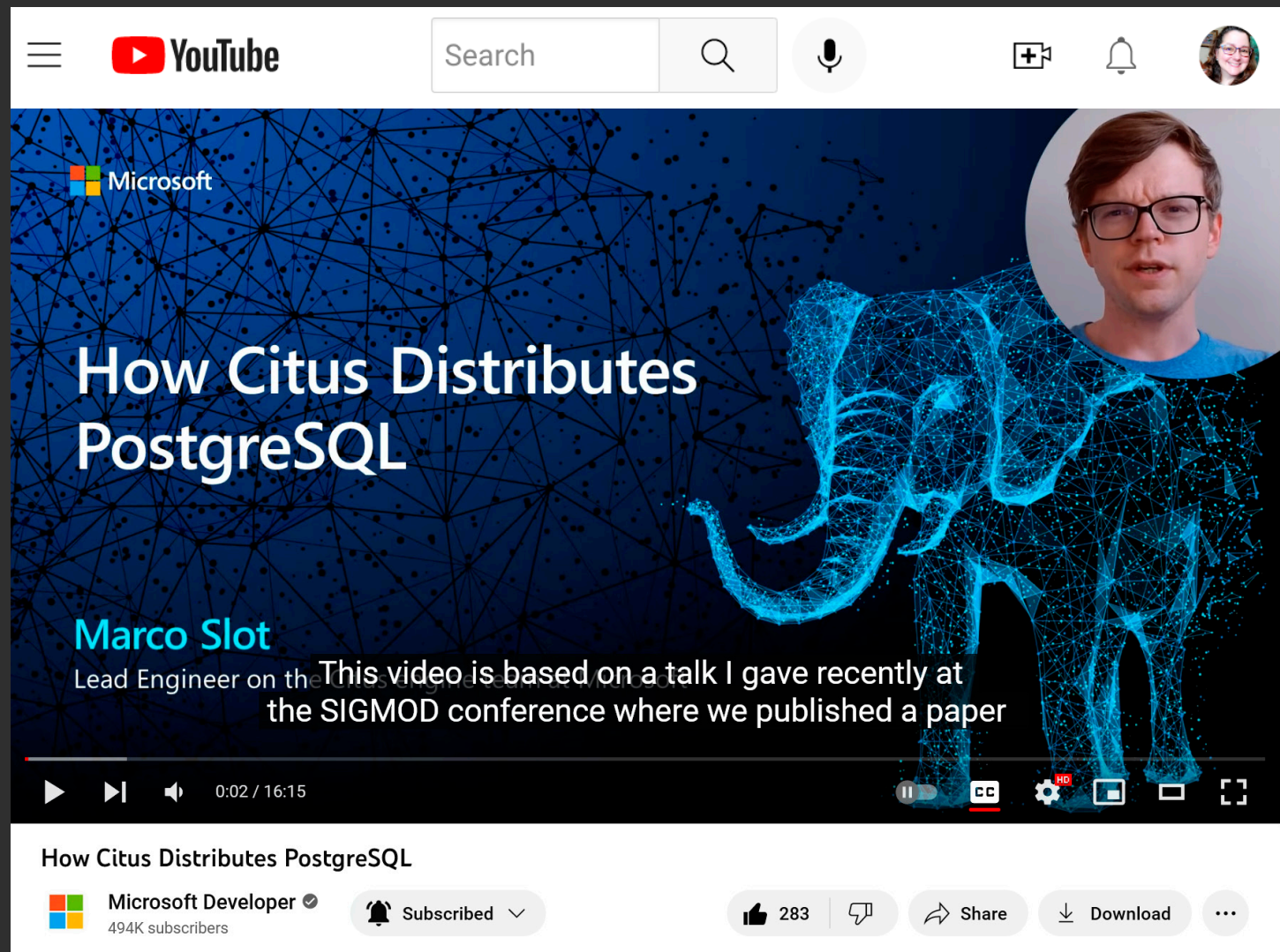
**Some people learn
better via video**

3

Use Video to show how you use Postgres

How you solved a problem,
what you learned,
how you solved something

Source: aka.ms/how-citus-distributes-postgres



3

Good video metadata will help your video get discovered

- Titles should be compelling
- Frontload w/ most important words because.....
- YouTube truncates title @ 70 chars

The screenshot shows a YouTube video player and its description page. Annotations with arrows point to the following elements:

- Thumbnail**: Points to the video thumbnail image showing a man's face and a wireframe elephant.
- Title**: Points to the video title "How Citus Distributes PostgreSQL".
- Hashtags**: Points to the video description, which contains the hashtags #PostgreSQL and #Citus.
- Description**: Points to the main body of the video description text.
- Bookmarks**: Points to the "Video bookmarks" section, which lists time-stamped chapters.
- Links**: Points to the "Learn more" section, which contains links to the Citus open source repository, getting started guide, and SIGMOD 2021 paper.
- Chapters**: Points to the "Key moments" section, which displays a timeline of video chapters with their start times.

Video Title: How Citus Distributes PostgreSQL

Description: This video is based on a talk I gave recently at the SIGMOD conference where we published a paper. This talk by the Citus technical lead is about what Citus is, how Citus uses the PostgreSQL extension APIs to transform Postgres into a distributed database. Marco Slot explains how Citus works, what you need to know about the new table types Citus introduces (distributed tables and reference tables), what the distributed query planner does, and how Citus handles distributed database transactions. Marco also explores the 4 application workloads that often need to scale Postgres—including multi-tenant SaaS apps, customer-facing analytics dashboards, as well as more traditional key value workloads with lots of JSON data. Finally, Marco shares the results of performance benchmarks such as HammerDB TPC-DC and YCSB to compare the performance of a single Postgres node, a single Citus node, a Citus 4-node database cluster, and an 8-node cluster. Citus is available as open source and in the cloud as Hyperscale (Citus), an option in the Azure Database for PostgreSQL managed service. This talk was inspired by a paper Marco delivered on distributed Postgres and Citus at the SIGMOD 2021 conference—link to the paper is below. We hope you enjoy it.

Video bookmarks:

- 0:30 What is Citus?
- 1:17 Four workload patterns that need to scale PostgreSQL
- 5:29 What is a Postgres extension?
- 5:42 How Citus works
- 14:28 Performance benchmarking of Citus

Let's connect:

- Twitter - @marcoslot, @marcoslot
- Twitter - @citusdata, @citusdata
- Twitter - @AzureDBPostgres, @azuredbpostgres

Subscribe to our Citus technical newsletter:
<https://aka.ms/citus-newsletter>

Learn more:

- Citus open source repository: <https://github.com/citusdata/citus>
- Getting started with Citus: <https://aka.ms/get-started-with-citus>
- Citus paper at SIGMOD 2021: <https://aka.ms/citus-sigmod-paper-2021>

Key moments

Time	Chapter Title
0:30	What is Citus?
1:17	Four workload patterns that need to...
5:29	What is a Postgres extension?
5:42	How Citus works
14:28	Performance benchmarking of Citus



**Promoting on
social media
reaches more ppl,
grows ecosystem**

4

So many PG things to signal boost on social

your learnings,
user stories,
meetups,
talks attended,
TIL, QOTD, OH, how-to,
new releases



Claire Giordano ✨ at #PASSDataSummit 🌟
@clairegiordano

Dry runs for conference talks relax me / practicing in the real place w/all the details is weirdly reassuring

Some pics from rehearsal today of @ShireeshThota's
#PASSDataSummit keynote for @Microsoft today in Seattle!

Happening Wed 11/15 @ 8:15am PST w/ @bobwardms @AnalyticAnna



8:45 PM · Nov 14, 2023 from Seattle, WA · 1,132 Views

4

Where to promote & share?

 Mastodon

 Slack

 Twitter

 Reddit

 LinkedIn

 Discord

 Threads

 #irc IRC





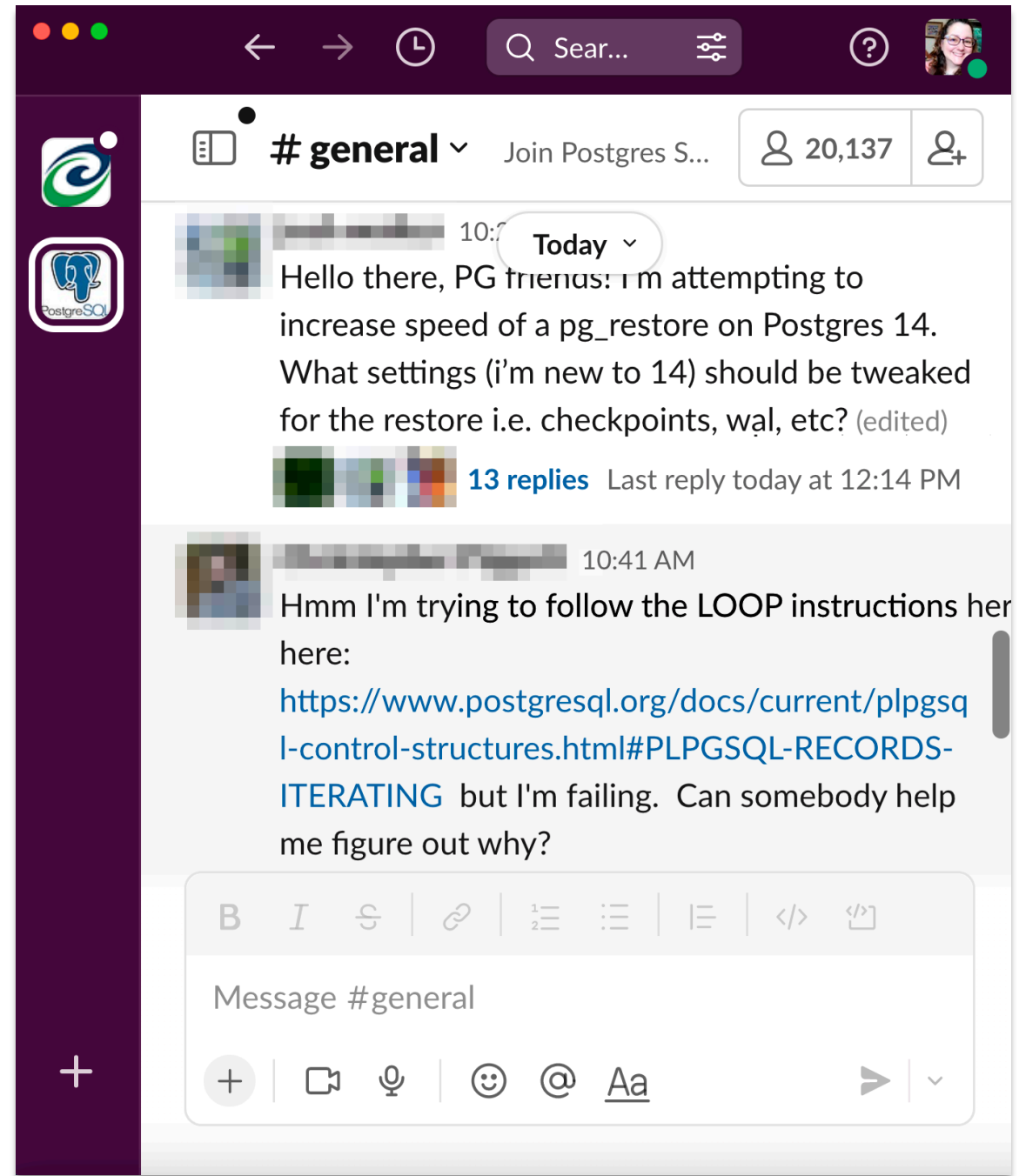
5

**Join in the
online Q&A**

5

Join in online Q&A to ask questions, share your perspective

- PostgreSQL Slack
- IRC
- Stack Overflow #postgresql
- Reddit: PostgreSQL, SQL, ...





Attend Conferences

6

Be part of Hallway Track @ Conferences

- Meet people / Make friends
- Volunteer to help with event
- Great way to learn about PG



PGConf.EU 2023

The 13th Annual PostgreSQL Conference Europe

Prague, Czechia

December 12–15, 2023

PostgreSQL Europe is proud to announce the 13th Annual PostgreSQL Conference Europe which will be held at the Clarion Congress Hotel Prague in Prague, Czechia, on December 13–15, 2023 with an additional day of world-class PostgreSQL training offered on December 12.



**Run, host, &
support local
meetups**

7

Meetups always need help

- Need organizers
- Your company can donate meeting space
- Need \$\$\$ for food/drink
- Need speakers

Source: @PostgreSQLNL, @OptimaDataBV





Docs feedback

Docs feedback is a gift too!

- Clarify
- Fix ambiguities
- Bring the “new person” perspective to docs & help improve for other newbies!

Submit correction

If you see anything in the documentation that is not correct, does not match your experience with the particular feature or requires further clarification, please use **this form** to report a documentation issue.



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**“Submit correction” link
@ bottom of each docs
page takes you here**

Submit documentation comment

Found something in the documentation that is incorrect, does not match your experience with a particular feature, or requires further clarification?

Please fill out the form below with your name, email, subject, and a detailed description about what you are commenting on. After clicking the button below, an email will be sent to the pgsql-docs@lists.postgresql.org mailing list.

By submitting this form, you agree that all of its contents, including your personal information as listed, will be posted to the public pgsql-docs@lists.postgresql.org mailing list, and archived in the public list archives.

Your Name:

Your Email:

Source: [postgresql.org](https://www.postgresql.org)



Report bugs with Postgres



Report bugs with Postgres

“When you find a bug with Postgres we want to hear about it.”

“Your bug reports play an important part in making PostgreSQL more reliable.”

5. Bug Reporting Guidelines

5.1. Identifying Bugs

5.2. What to Report

5.3. Where to Report Bugs

When you find a bug in PostgreSQL we want to hear about it. Your bug reports play an important part in making PostgreSQL more reliable because even the utmost care cannot guarantee that every part of PostgreSQL will work on every platform under every circumstance.

The following suggestions are intended to assist you in forming bug reports that can be handled in an effective fashion. No one is required to follow them but doing so tends to be to everyone's advantage.

We cannot promise to fix every bug right away. If the bug is obvious, critical, or affects a lot of users, chances are good that someone will look into it. It could also happen that we tell you to update to a newer version to see if the bug happens there. Or we might decide that the bug cannot be fixed before some major rewrite we might be planning is done. Or perhaps it is simply too hard and there are more important things on the agenda. If you need help immediately, consider obtaining a commercial support contract.

Source: [postgresql.org](https://www.postgresql.org)



WHERE to report bugs

1. Mailing list, or
2. Bug report web-form here:
postgresql.org/account/submitbug/
3. Unless it's a security issue!

5.3. Where to Report Bugs

In general, send bug reports to the bug report mailing list at `<pgsql-bugs@lists.postgresql.org>`. You are requested to use a descriptive subject for your email message, perhaps parts of the error message.

Another method is to fill in the bug report web-form available at the project's **web site**. Entering a bug report this way causes it to be mailed to the `<pgsql-bugs@lists.postgresql.org>` mailing list.

If your bug report has security implications and you'd prefer that it not become immediately visible in public archives, don't send it to `pgsql-bugs`. Security issues can be reported privately to `<security@postgresql.org>`.

Source: postgresql.org



Security issues are special



5.3. Where to Report Bugs

In general, send bug reports to the bug report mailing list at `<pgsql-bugs@lists.postgresql.org>`. You are requested to use a descriptive subject for your email message, perhaps parts of the error message.

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User testing



User testing

- Your own applications
- New PG Beta, RC releases
- New features
- **Also, tell the PG community when things work!**

Imaginary email....

To: [pgsql-hackers](#)
Lists: [pgsql-hackers](#)

Just tested our application FOOBAR (a multi-tenant SaaS application) with the RC 1 release of PG16 and wanted to let y'all that it worked!



Translations

Help with message translations

- Mailing list: pgsql-translators
- More info: babel.postgresql.org
- Instructions in Postgres docs: “Native Language support”

NLS Status Tables

The tables below shows which areas of the PostgreSQL source are prepared for translation, and the progress of those translations. The numbers are percents of translated messages. By following the links, you can download freshly baked PO files that are merged up against the latest program sources. No PostgreSQL source tree is needed for translation work.

The **highlighted** boxes are the files that have a sufficient fraction of strings translated to be considered for release. Files that are **100%** translated are specially highlighted. All other files will not be part of the PostgreSQL release.

The grey numbers are translations that do not exist yet, but where this web site has initialized the translations files for you with data from the existing translations for the same language.

You can work in several branches. Please see the status information below and follow the announcements on the [mailing list](#) ([subscribe](#)) about when a branch is about to be released.

16 branch

Last update: Wed Nov 15 2023 13:22:32 GMT-0800 (Pacific Standard Time)

	af	cs	de	el	es	fa	fr	he	hr	hu	id	it	ja	ka	ko	nb	nl
ecpg (130 strings)		93	100	100	100		100	3	3	1	10	100	100	100	100	2	1
ecpglib (32 strings)		100	100	100	100		100					100	100	100	100		
initdb (190 strings)		72	100	99	100		100	36	5	1	15	92	100	100	100	4	6
libpq (289 strings)	3	18	100	100	100		100	15	3	1	5	20	100	100	100	3	
pg_amcheck (97 strings)		20	100	100	100	1	100	12	2	1	4	100	100	100	100	5	
pg_archivecleanup (27 strings)		88	100	100	100		100	7			7	100	100	100	100	11	3
pg_basebackup (329 strings)		74	100	100	100		100	15	1	1	6	98	100	100	100	3	2

Translations really need help!

- Italian was “saved at the last minute” because of this call for help during PG 15

↻ Thomas Munro Retweeted



Dan Langille
@DLangille

...

Can you translate into Polish, Brazilian Portuguese, or Korean? The [#PostgreSQL](#) project could use your help translating some files for an upcoming release.



Álvaro Herrera @alvherre · Aug 8

There's A LOT of translation catalogs for languages previously well-maintained that are going away for PostgreSQL 15, because they're outdated.

We're missing translators! Check out your language and contribute: babel.postgresql.org

[Show this thread](#)



Says Álvaro Herrera: “Volunteers = welcome!”

- for message translations
- to create nice/friendly tooling
- to coordinate translation of documentation

Postgres 11 had 14 translations	Postgres 16 has just 11 “Survivors”
Czech	
French	French
German	German
Italian	Italian
Japanese	Japanese
Korean	Korean
Polish	
Portuguese	
PRC Chinese	
Russian	Russian
Spanish	Spanish
Swedish	Swedish
Turkish	
Vietnamese	
	Greek, Georgian, Ukrainian



**Graphics & visuals
pull people in**

12

Use your design skills /Graphics & visuals pull people in

PostgreSQL 16 release artwork design
contest that Mark Wong ran on 99designs

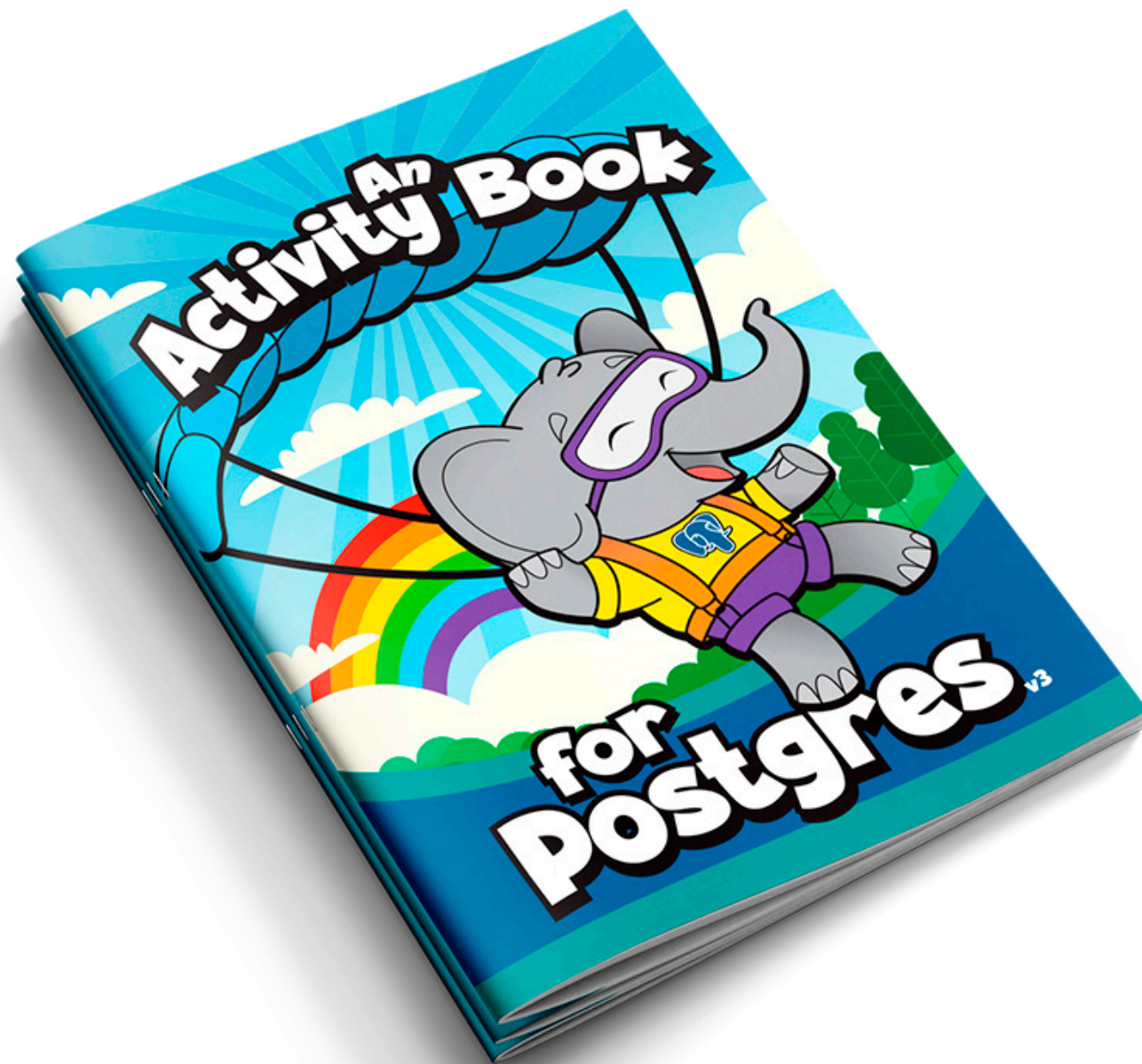
Winner



Source: <https://99designs.com/illustrations/contests/postgresql-v-release-artwork-1239210>

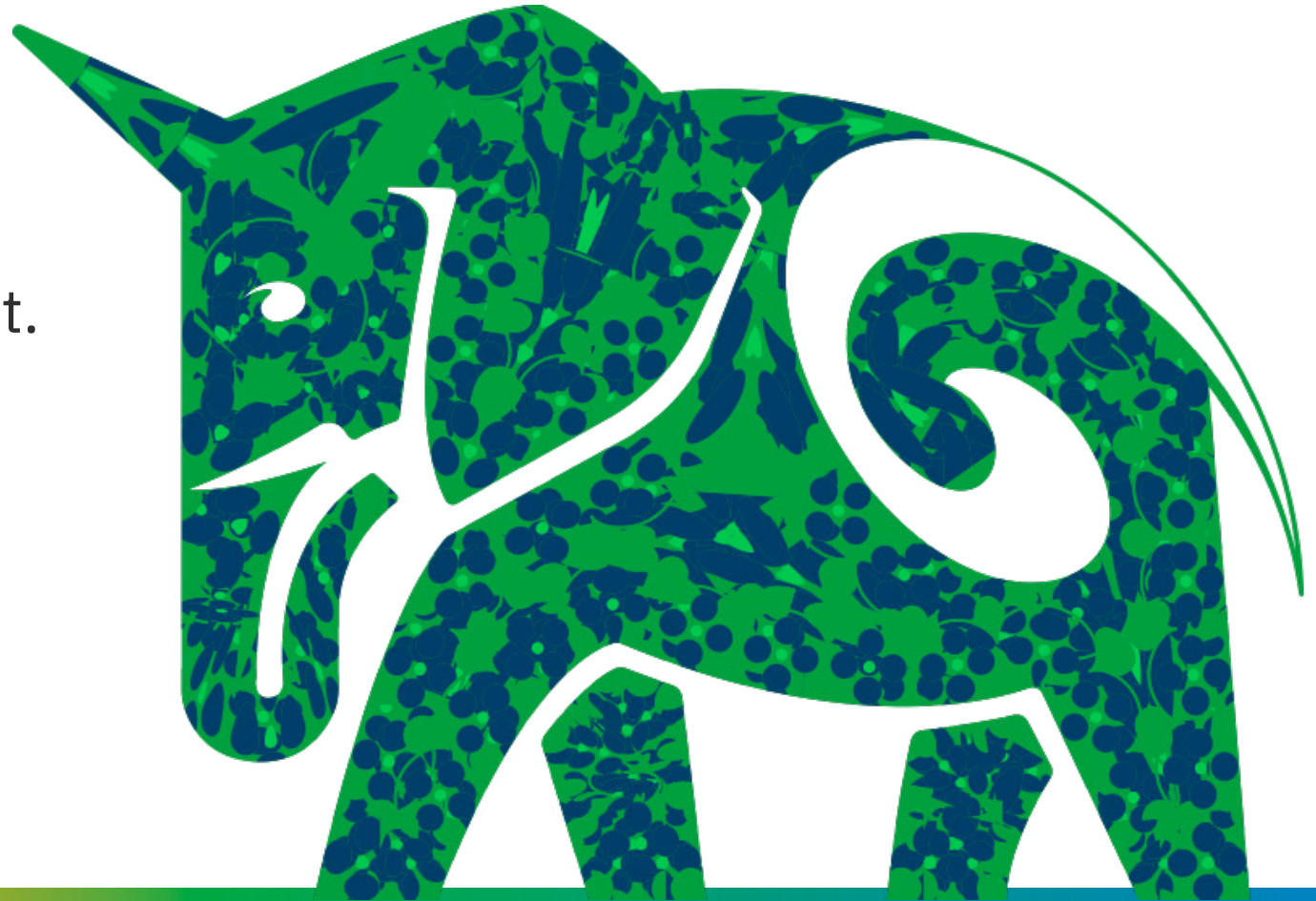
12

Use your design skills
/ **Graphics & visuals**
pull people in



Use your design skills / **Graphics & visuals** pull people in

“Elicorn” = Citus open source mascot.





Use “Sketchnotes”

13

Use “Sketchnotes” to share your learnings

Combine words, lettering styles, color, sketches, bullets



Source: twitter.com/reverentgeek

Visual note-taking aka “sketchnotes” do 2 things: reinforce learning & give you an asset you can share!

1) reinforce learning

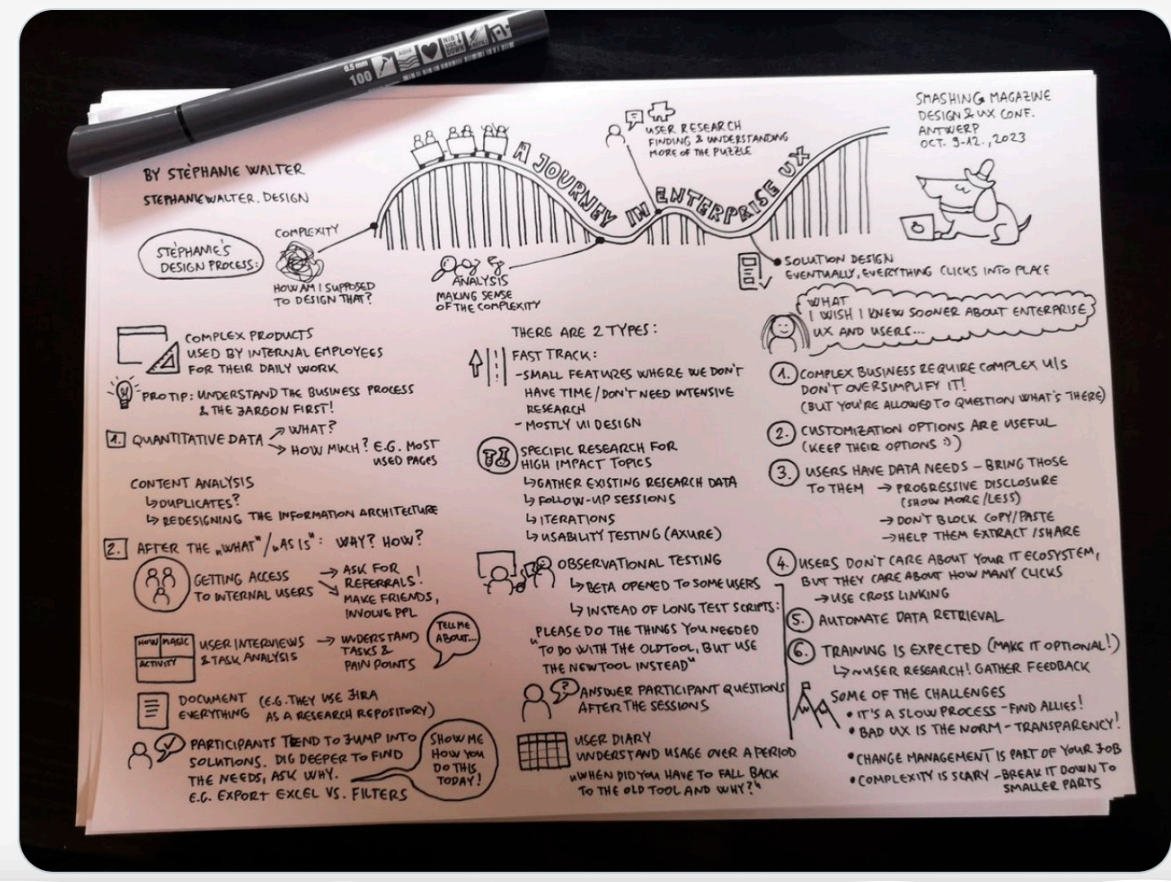
2) give you an asset you can share!



Krisztina Szerovay @krisztaszerovay · Oct 10

Her design process in enterprise UX looks like this:

- Complexity: How am I supposed to design that?
- Analysis: Making sense of this complexity
- Research: Finding & understanding the puzzle pieces
- Solution design: Eventually, everything clicks into place



Source: twitter.com/krisztaszerovay



Sponsorships



Sponsor Conferences & PGDays

Call for Sponsorships is
now open!

#PASSDataCommunitySummit

The 8th Annual pgDay Paris



Paris, France – March 14–15, 2024

PostgreSQL Europe is proud to announce the 8th Annual pgDay Paris which will be held at Espace Saint-Martin in Paris, France, on March 14, 2024.

There will be an extra day of training on Friday, March 15 at additional cost.



Recognition matters



**Shine a bright light on
other people's work.
Recognition matters.**

- Privately. Publicly. Both.
- Beyond code
- Not just developers

**PostgreSQL Person
of the Week**

#PostgresFriends

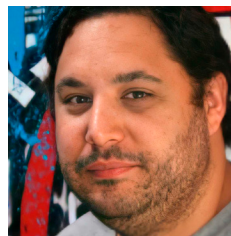
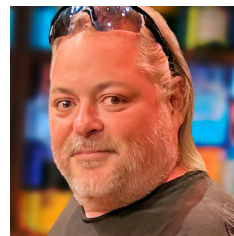
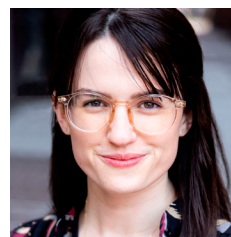
created by Andreas Scherbaum

15

Example:
Path To Citus Con
podcast for
developers who
love Postgres

- Human side of Postgres
- + databases, open source
- + PG extensions too

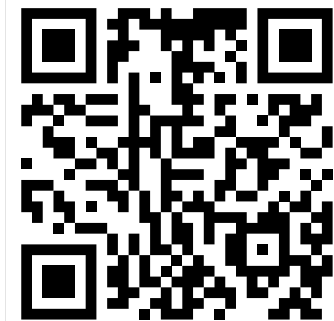




Topics:



- ▶ Working in public
- ▶ PostGIS
- ▶ How I got started
- ▶ Conference talks
- ▶ Favorite ways to learn
- ▶ For app developers



Path to Citus Con

A new podcast for developers who love Postgres

→ aka.ms/PathToCitusCon

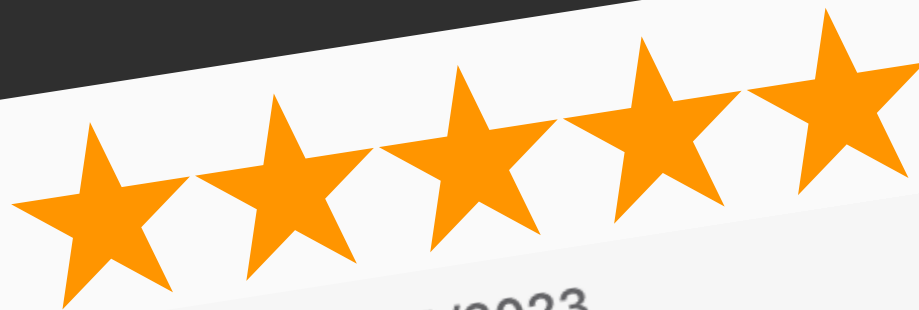
15

p.s.

**Ratings & Reviews
help new listeners
discover**

**(& help podcasters
know it's useful!)**

→ **aka.ms/PathToCitCon**



kjb0514, 09/06/2023

A Niche Gem

Path To Citus Con is the niche gem anyone involved with Postgres needs in their lives. Claire and Pino are engaging and knowledgeable hosts and their guests always have something great [more](#)



Say thank you

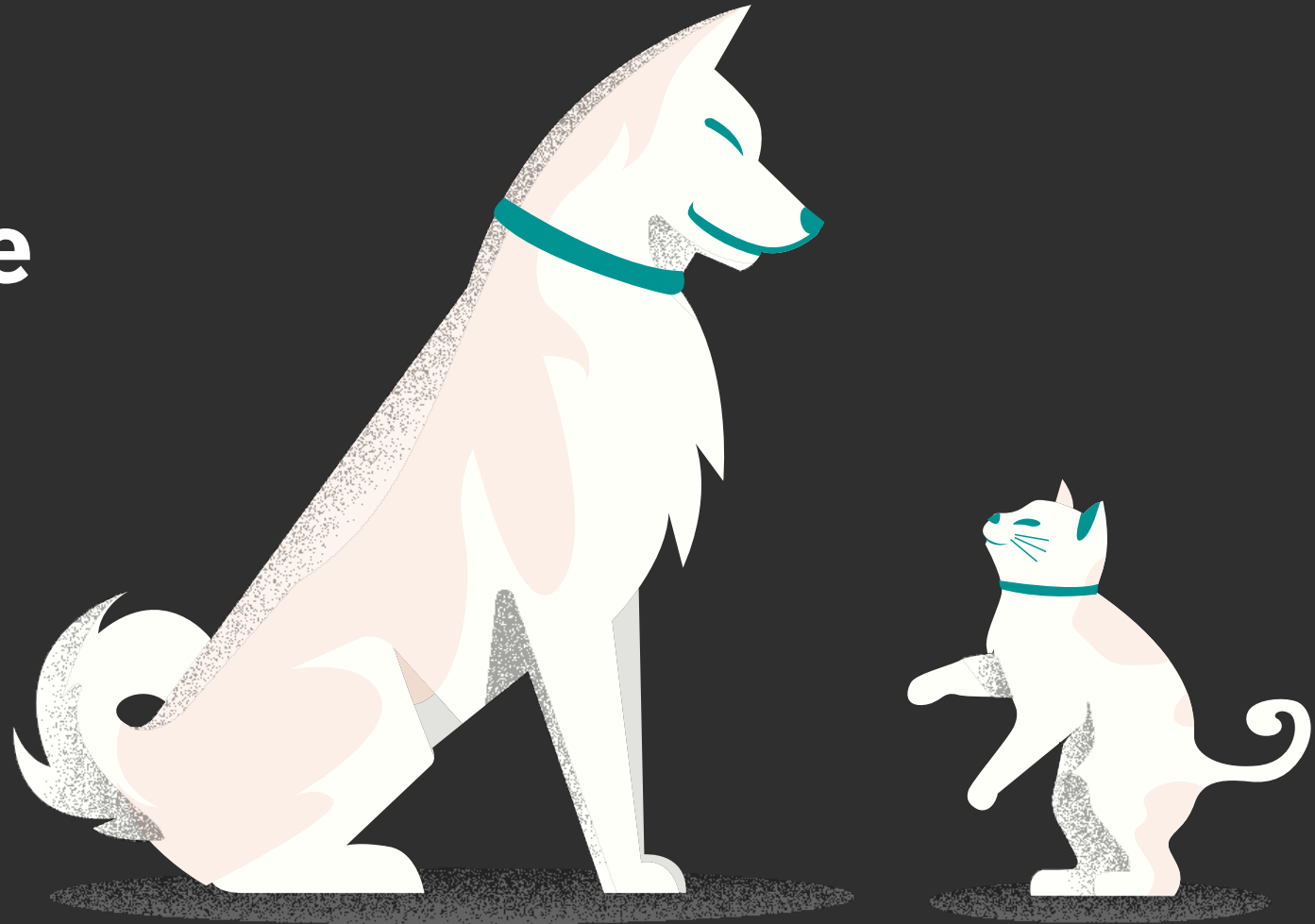
Say thank you. If you like someone's work, praise it.

- Privately. Publicly. Both.
- Especially junior & new people
- Not just luminaries & friends



**Say thank you to
conference speakers
whose talks you have
learned from**

**You will MAKE.
THEIR. DAY.**





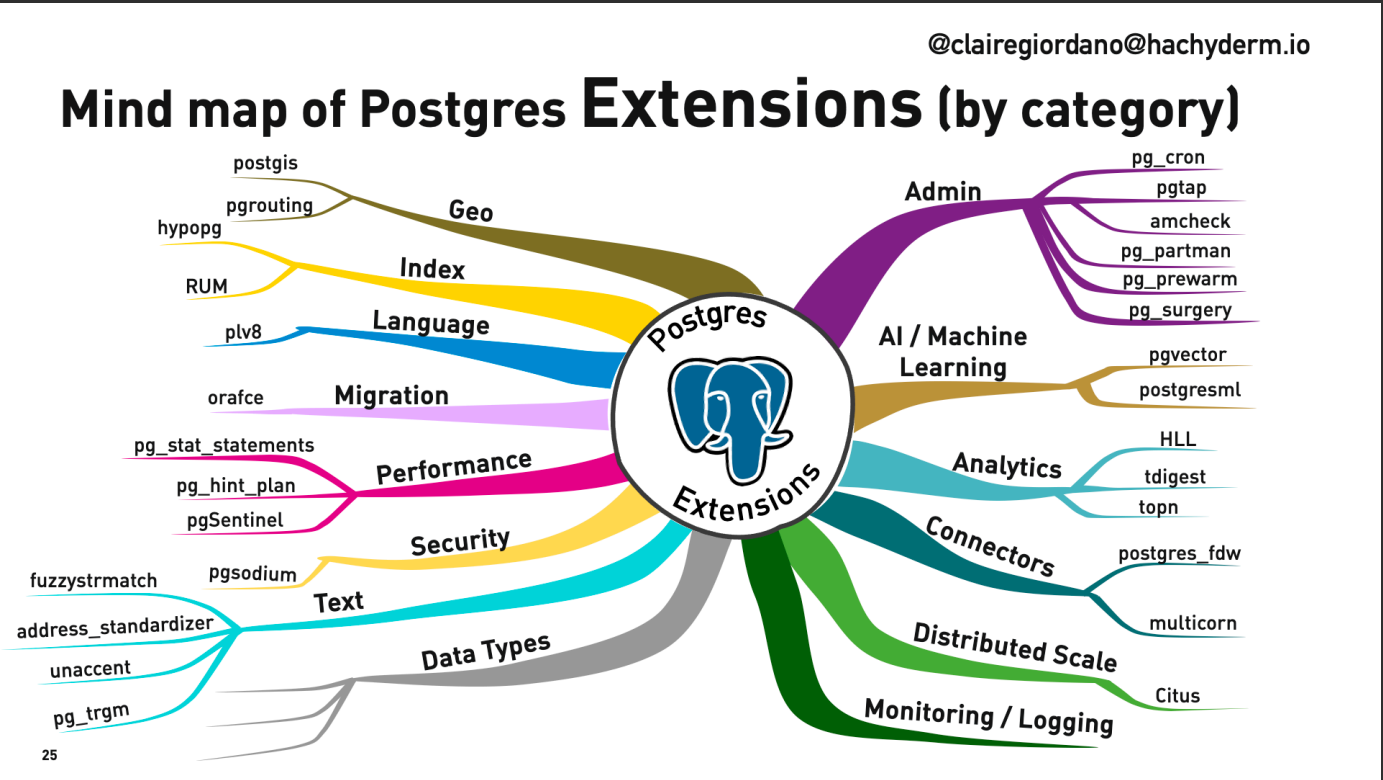
**Don't forget
Postgres
extensions!**

17

Might be easier to
get involved with a
smaller ecosystem
project first

See my talk from
PGConf NYC 2023

<https://aka.ms/Claire-PGConfNYC2023-extensions>



17 Ways to Get Involved With Postgres

SHARE

1. User experiences
2. Today I Learned / My First 6 Months
3. Video Demos
4. Social Media

CONVERSATION

5. Online Q&A
6. Hallway Track @ Events
7. Support Meetups

FEEDBACK

8. Doc feedback
9. Report bugs
10. Test new releases

DONATE

11. Language skills
12. Design skills
13. #Sketchnotes skills
14. Sponsorships

INSPIRE

15. Shine light on others
16. Say thank you!

EXTENSIONS

17. Check out Extensions!

Thanks & credits & inspiration go to

- Josh Berkus
- Samay Sharma
- Thomas Munro
- Rob Treat
- Melanie Plageman
- Simon Willison
- Lætitia Avrot
- Isaac Alves
- Marco Slot
- Ryan Booz
- Charles Feddersen



Thanks to all the Postgres speakers @ #PASSDataSummit I'm learning from!



#PASSDataCommunitySummit



Thank you

and be sure to check out my new podcast @ aka.ms/PathToCitusCon
Path To Citus Con for developers who love Postgres



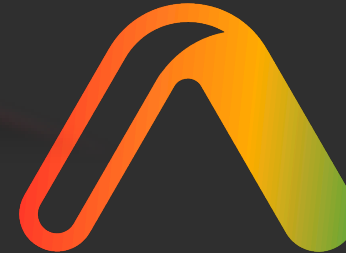
Claire Giordano

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 [@clairegiordano](https://www.instagram.com/clairegiordano)

 [@clairegiordano](https://twitter.com/clairegiordano)

 [@AzureDBPostgres](https://twitter.com/AzureDBPostgres) |  [@citusdata](https://twitter.com/citusdata)



PASS
Data Community
SUMMIT

